



Missing L2 caches, installer problems, Explorer crashes, Firmware upgrades, DOOMed installers, etc. You've got a problem? We've got the solution

Where's my L2 gone?

I want to know what the L2 cache memory is, and why it is marked as 0 MB on my system. I have an Intel Celeron 1.7 GHz, 128 MB SDRAM, a 40 GB Seagate hard disk, a Mercury KOB82845 G/GL NDSMx motherboard with the Intel 845 GL chipset, onboard VGA and sound.

According to your October issue, a Pentium 4 has 256 KB of L2 cache, but my machine has 0 MB. I asked my computer vendor, but he knows nothing

about it. My friend's PC, a Pentium 3, shows 256 KB of L2 cache. The performance of his computer is good.

I used the 'trial-and-error' method on the external cache option provided in the BIOS, but there was no performance difference. My friend's PC has DDR RAM. Is the L2 cache dependent on the type of RAM? Please help.

Gaurav Malji

All CPUs have an inbuilt L2 cache, and it isn't dependent on the type of system

memory you have, or anything like that. The L2 cache, which increases the CPU's performance, is inbuilt in the processor.

A Celeron 1.7 GHz processor should have 128 KB of L2 cache. There are two possibilities: the first is that the L2 cache is disabled in the BIOS, in which case you'll have to enable it. The other possibility is that the program you're using reports the cache status incorrectly. To verify this, press the

[Pause] key when your system's hardware information is displayed. This information appears as a table just after you've switched on your PC, and just before Windows starts. You'll need to be a little quick, or you'll miss the screen. Look at this table, and you'll be able to view the correct system information.

Unhandled Exception while installing

I have a Pentium III 450 MHz computer with Windows 98 SE. The problem is that recently, I tried to install the demo version of *Clive Barker's Undying*. The installer for the game comes with the Install Shield Wizard—the newer one, with the soft-blue icon. The installer showed that it was reading the packages. Then, a box popped up showing that setup was preparing the Install shield wizard, along with the progress bar. Everything was fine until this point. Then, a message box popped up saying, "Unhandled Exception". The exact error message said: "Error number: 0x80070725 Description: Incompatible version of the RPC stub Setup will now terminate".

Another interesting fact is that this now happens for every installer that uses Install Shield. I've installed the game before, and it ran fine then. Also, the disks I installed from were clean, so the error is not with the source.

I updated my drivers, and reinstalled DirectX9. There was no change. The one

Processor	Speeds	Cache
1 Celeron	300.00 MHz, 266.00 MHz, 2.80 GHz, 2.70 GHz, 1.80 GHz, 2.80 GHz, 2.40 GHz, 2.50 GHz, 2.20 GHz, 2.10 GHz, 2.00 GHz, 1.80 GHz, 1.70 GHz, 1.10 GHz, 1.00 GHz, 950.00 MHz, 900.00 MHz, 850.00 MHz, 800.00 MHz, 798.00 MHz, 733.00 MHz, 700.00 MHz, 667.00 MHz, 625.00 MHz, 600.00 MHz, 566.00 MHz, 533.00 MHz, 500.00 MHz, 466.00 MHz, 433.00 MHz, 400.00 MHz, 366.00 MHz, 333.00 MHz, 300.00 MHz	0.1A
2 Celeron	1.40 GHz, 1.30 GHz, 1.20 GHz, 1.10 GHz, 1.00 GHz	128 KB
3 Celeron	1.80 GHz, 1.55 GHz, 1.20 GHz, 1.15 GHz, 1.10 GHz, 1.00 GHz, 933.00 MHz, 900.00 MHz, 866.00 MHz, 800.00 MHz, 750.00 MHz, 733.00 MHz, 700.00 MHz, 667.00 MHz, 625.00 MHz, 600.00 MHz, 566.00 MHz, 533.00 MHz, 500.00 MHz	128 KB
4 Pentium III	1.40 GHz, 1.28 GHz, 1.15 GHz, 1.10 GHz, 933.00 MHz, 800.00 MHz, 400.00 MHz	256 KB
5 Pentium III	1.00 GHz, 933.00 MHz, 800.00 MHz, 400.00 MHz	512 KB
6 Pentium III	1.00 GHz, 1.80 GHz, 1.40 GHz, 1.30 GHz, 1.40 GHz, 1.30 GHz	256 KB
7 Pentium III	2.00 GHz, 1.80 GHz, 1.80 GHz, 1.70 GHz, 1.60 GHz, 1.50 GHz, 1.40 GHz, 1.30 GHz	256 KB
8 Pentium III	3.20 GHz, 3.00 GHz, 3.00 GHz, 2.80 GHz, 2.80 GHz, 2.80 GHz, 2.30 GHz, 2.30 GHz, 2.40 GHz, 2.20 GHz, 2.20 GHz, 2.00 GHz, 1.80 GHz, 1.80 GHz	512 KB
9 Pentium III	3.40 GHz, 3.20 GHz, 3.20 GHz, 2.80 GHz	1 MB
Source: http://processordatabase.com/scripts/list.asp		

This chart shows the different combinations of processor and cache that are available